



HiddenGem Media

HOW TO SPEAK OUR ICP'S LANGUAGE

# Industry Acumen – Hotel & Resort Terminology

Session 2 of 2: fourteen terms in about 60 minutes



why direct pays · is the marketing working? · the stack · two rounds of practice and a sort

# Where we left off

Session 1 in four lines. Everything today builds on these.

1



**The profit ladder**

Total revenue, then GOP (gross operating profit), then NOI (net operating income). The buyer prices the bottom rung.

2



**Sold, or available?**

ADR (average daily rate) is what a sold room went for. RevPAR (revenue per available room) counts the empty ones too.

3



**What did they leave out?**

The qualifier is the question: “basically full”, “best summer yet”.

4



**Ask which number it is before you react to it**

The habit that survives any trim.

# Today in three blocks



## Block 4: why direct pays

- 01 Metasearch
- 02 Cap rate
- 03 First-party data
- 04 Effective commission



## Block 5: is the marketing working?

- 01 CPM
- 02 UTM
- 03 CAPI
- 04 Incrementality
- 05 Cannibalization



## Block 6: the stack

- 01 The tools map
- 02 Rate shopping and market intelligence tools
- 03 CRM tools
- 04 Guest messaging tools
- 05 Upsell tools

# Block 4: why direct pays

Four terms that put a number on a direct booking: where guests compare your price, what a buyer pays for your profit, what you own when the guest books with you, and what it really cost to win them.

01



## Metasearch

Where a guest sees your price next to the OTAs' (online travel agencies).

02



## Cap rate

What a buyer pays for your profit.

03



## First-party data

What you own when the guest books with you.

04



## Effective commission

What it really cost to win them.

# Metasearch

where guests compare your price



## Dictionary

Google Hotel Ads, Tripadvisor, Trivago — rate comparison that passes traffic on to a booking channel.



## Why the owner cares

Their direct price sits next to Booking.com's and Expedia's on the same screen, and the click that lands on their own site is a booking they keep. It is also where last week's rate parity becomes visible to the guest.



## Contextual usage

Guests comparing prices on Google or Tripadvisor are on metasearch — are you showing up there with your direct rate?

WHAT A GUEST SEES WHEN THEY SEARCH LAKESIDE LODGE ON GOOGLE

### Lakeside Lodge



Overview

Prices

Reviews

Photos

About

Sponsored · Featured options



Expedia.ca

Free Wi-Fi · Free breakfast

\$200

Visit site



Preferred Hotels & Resorts

Free Wi-Fi · Free breakfast

\$200

Visit site



Booking.com

Free Wi-Fi

\$200

Visit site



Lakeside Lodge

Official Site

\$200

Visit site



trivago DEALS

Free Wi-Fi · Free breakfast

\$200

Visit site

Same public price everywhere. The official-site line is the click that lands on her site.

# Cap rate

capitalization rate: what a buyer pays for NOI



## Dictionary

The yield a buyer prices the property at, applied to NOI.



## Why the owner cares

It turns NOI into what the place is worth, so every dollar added to NOI adds many dollars to the value of their life's work. Buyers start from the cap rate; the price falls out of it.



## Contextual usage

A higher NOI at the same cap rate means the property is worth more — that's the long game.



**NOI ÷ Purchase price**

The buyer is back. Lakeside Lodge made **\$900,000** of NOI over the last twelve months; the offer is **\$12,000,000**. What cap rate is that?

$$\text{Cap rate} = \$900,000 \div \$12,000,000 = 7.5\%$$



**Therefore, cap rate = 7.5% (the price is 13.3 × NOI)**

HOW A BUYER ARRIVES AT 7.5%, THEN AT THE PRICE

- 1 Comparable sales: what similar lodges sold for, relative to NOI
- 2 The return they need: more risk or dearer borrowing, higher cap rate
- 3 Then the price:  $\text{NOI} \div \text{cap rate} = \$900,000 \div 7.5\% = \$12,000,000$
- 4 Add \$75,000 of NOI and the lodge is worth about \$1,000,000 more

# First-party data the guest data you own



## Dictionary

Guest data the property owns outright, which is most of why direct matters.



## Why the owner cares

Owning the guest relationship means next year's stay without paying commission again. A direct booking is worth its price plus everything that comes with the guest.



## Contextual usage

Every direct booking gives you first-party data — the guest's email is yours, not the OTA's.

### WHO HOLDS THE GUEST, AND WHAT COMES WITH THEM



#### Booked via OTA

- Booking.com has the guest's email and the stay history.
- The guest is Booking.com's to re-market.
- Next year's stay pays commission again.



#### Booked direct

- The email: next year's stay, no commission.
- The data: retargeting and lookalike audiences start from this list.
- The pre-arrival upsell: spa, dinner, a better room.
- The review and the referral come to the lodge.
- Direct bookings tend to cancel less.

# Effective commission

what it really cost to win the booking



## Dictionary

The full cost of winning a booking as a percentage of its value, so a direct booking and an OTA booking compare on one line.



## Why the owner cares

It puts a direct booking and an OTA booking on one line, which is the comparison owners actually make. And unlike an OTA's cut, it is a cost HGM can bring down.



## Contextual usage

Once we count ad spend and discounts too, what's your effective commission on a direct booking compared with Booking.com?



**Total cost of winning the booking ÷ Gross booking value**

A guest booked five nights at Lakeside Lodge direct, a **\$1,500** stay. The Meta ads that brought them cost **\$150**. Through Booking.com, the same stay would have carried a **\$225** commission.

Direct:  $\$150 \div \$1,500 = 10\%$   
Booking.com:  $\$225 \div \$1,500 = 15\%$



**Therefore, effective commission = 10% direct, 15% on Booking.com**

THE SAME \$1,500 STAY, TWO WAYS



Both costs are made up. The point is the one line they sit on.

# Odd one out



One term, four statements about it. Three are true. One is the common mistake.



Hold up the number of the odd one out.



Three, two, one, vote. Everyone commits at once.

# Which one is the mistake?

ODD ONE OUT · 1 OF 4

## Metasearch

Priya's hotel just showed up on Google next to Booking.com and Expedia. Three of these are true about where she's showing up. One is the common mistake.

- 1 It compares prices and passes the guest on to wherever they click
- 2 Google, Tripadvisor and trivago are the big ones
- 3 It takes the booking, the way an OTA does
- 4 Her own website's price can be listed there, next to the OTAs'



ODD ONE OUT · 1 OF 4

## Cast your vote

- 1 Compares, passes on
- 2 Google, Tripadvisor
- 3 Takes the booking
- 4 Her price is listed

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Which one is the mistake?

## Metasearch

- 1 It compares prices and passes the guest on to wherever they click
- 2 Google, Tripadvisor and trivago are the big ones
- 3 It takes the booking, the way an OTA does
- 4 Her own website's price can be listed there, next to the OTAs'

### WHY

Statement 3 is the mistake. **Metasearch compares and passes the guest on; it doesn't take the booking.** The OTAs do that. Click Priya's line and the booking lands on her site; click Expedia and Expedia takes its cut.

**"Guests comparing prices on Google or Tripadvisor are on metasearch. Are you showing up there with your direct rate?"**



THE ANSWER

## The answer

- 1 Compares, passes on
- 2 Google, Tripadvisor
- 3  Takes the booking
- 4 Her price is listed

# Which one isn't first-party?

ODD ONE OUT · 2 OF 4

## First-party data

Theo is happy that Booking.com handles the guest emails for his OTA bookings. Three of these are first-party data. One isn't.

- 1 The guest's details on the Booking.com extranet
- 2 A guest's email, collected when they booked on his site
- 3 His own booking history, going back years
- 4 The spa booking the guest added in his PMS



ODD ONE OUT · 2 OF 4

## Cast your vote

- 1 The OTA extranet
- 2 Email his site took
- 3 His booking history
- 4 Spa booking, PMS

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Which one isn't first-party?

## First-party data

- 1 The guest's details on the Booking.com extranet
- 2 A guest's email, collected when they booked on his site
- 3 His own booking history, going back years
- 4 The spa booking the guest added in his PMS

### WHY

Statement 1 is the odd one. **The data an OTA about his guests isn't first-party, even if he can see some of it.** The relationship sits with Booking.com. The other three are his: collected by him, held in his systems.

**"Every direct booking gives you first-party data. The guest's email is yours, not the OTA's."**



THE ANSWER

## The answer

- ☒ 1 The OTA extranet

2 Email his site took

3 His booking history

4 Spa booking, PMS

# Which one is the mistake?

ODD ONE OUT · 3 OF 4

## Effective commission

Marisol's business partner says the ads are expensive. Three of these are true about effective commission. One is the mistake.

- 1 It counts the ad spend that won the booking, not just commission
- 2 It puts a direct booking and an OTA booking on one line
- 3 A discount given to win the booking counts too
- 4 It's always lower on a direct booking than on an OTA booking



ODD ONE OUT · 3 OF 4

## Cast your vote

- 1 Counts ad spend
- 2 One line, both ways
- 3 Discounts count too
- 4 Always lower direct

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Which one is the mistake?

## Effective commission

- 1 It counts the ad spend that won the booking, not just commission
- 2 It puts a direct booking and an OTA booking on one line
- 3 A discount given to win the booking counts too
- 4 **It's always lower on a direct booking than on an OTA booking**

### WHY

Statement 4 is the mistake. **Effective commission is a comparison, not a verdict.** A direct booking won with expensive ads and a deep discount can cost more than Booking.com's cut. That's why the number exists.

**"Once we count ad spend and discounts too, what's your effective commission on a direct booking compared with Booking.com?"**



THE ANSWER

## The answer

- 1 Counts ad spend
- 2 One line, both ways
- 3 Discounts count too
- ☒ 4 **Always lower direct**

# Which one is the mistake?

ODD ONE OUT · 4 OF 4

## Cap rate

Marisol's buyer is back with a second offer. Three of these are true about cap rate. One is the mistake.

- 1 It's NOI divided by the price
- 2 At the same NOI, a higher cap rate means a higher price
- 3 Buyers price a full year of NOI, not one good month
- 4 The same deal can be said as a multiple of NOI



ODD ONE OUT · 4 OF 4

## Cast your vote

- 1 NOI ÷ price
- 2 Higher rate, dearer
- 3 A full year of NOI
- 4 Also a multiple

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Which one is the mistake?

## Cap rate

- 1 It's NOI divided by the price
- 2 **At the same NOI, a higher cap rate means a higher price**
- 3 Buyers price a full year of NOI, not one good month
- 4 The same deal can be said as a multiple of NOI

### WHY

Statement 2 is the mistake, and it's the one that costs money. **At the same NOI, a higher cap rate means a lower price**, because the buyer wants more return on every dollar.  $\text{Price} = \text{NOI} \div \text{cap rate}$ , and dividing by a bigger number gives less.

**"A higher NOI at the same cap rate means the property is worth more. That's the long game."**



THE ANSWER

## The answer

- 1 NOI ÷ price
- 2 **Higher rate, dearer**
- 3 A full year of NOI
- 4 Also a multiple

# Block 5: is the marketing working?

Five terms about the ad numbers an owner will quote at you: what attention costs, how a booking gets traced, how it gets counted, and whether the ads created it or just took the credit.

01



## CPM

Cost per mille: the cost per thousand impressions.

02



## UTM

Urchin Tracking Module: the tags that make a link traceable.

03



## CAPI

Conversions API: counting the booking when the browser won't.

04



## Incrementality

Did the ad cause the booking?

05



## Cannibalization

When the promo moves revenue instead of adding it.

# CPM

cost per mille: the cost per thousand impressions



## Dictionary

Cost per thousand impressions — the ad number an owner is most likely to quote at you.



## Why the owner cares

It is the ad number they are most likely to quote at you, and the one we quote at each other. It is a price set by an auction nobody controls, and on its own it says what attention cost, not whether the ads brought bookings.



## Contextual usage

Your CPM went up this month, which usually means we're competing with more advertisers for the same people.



$$(\text{Ad spend} \div \text{Impressions}) \times 1,000$$

Lakeside Lodge's Meta ads spent **\$4,500** last month and were shown **500,000** times. What was the CPM?

$$\text{CPM} = (\$4,500 \div 500,000) \times 1,000$$



**Therefore, CPM = \$9**

### WHY CPM MOVES, AND WHY WE CAN'T SET IT

1

#### Meta is an auction, every second

Every impression is bid for. More advertisers in Q4, over the holidays or near a big launch, and the same budget buys fewer impressions.

2

#### We don't control the auction

We control the creative, the audience and the timing.

3

#### HGM's own launch-condition band, directional

Discovery campaigns at \$9 to \$11 per thousand. Not a promise.

# UTM

## Urchin Tracking Module: the tags that make a link traceable



### Dictionary

Link tags that make traffic traceable.



### Why the owner cares

It lets us show them which email or ad brought each booking, instead of asking them to take it on trust. At HGM every email link and every ad carries them, and on our own sites they are stamped onto the booking itself.



### Contextual usage

We tag every link with a UTM so we can see exactly which post or email brought each booking.

#### THE SAME TAGS ON AN EMAIL AND ON AN AD



#### An email link

- lakeside-lodge.example/?utm\_source=email&utm\_medium=welcome-flow&utm\_campaign=email-1
- The report reads: email / welcome flow / Email 1.
- Sent from GoHighLevel, every link tagged.



#### A Meta ad link

- lakeside-lodge.example/?utm\_source=facebook&utm\_medium=paid&utm\_campaign=retargeting
- The report reads: facebook / paid / retargeting.
- On our own sites the tags are written onto the booking record.

# CAPI conversions API: counting the booking when the browser won't



## Dictionary

Server-side event sending, which survives the browser blocking the pixel.



## Why the owner cares

It keeps bookings visible to the ad platform when a guest's browser blocks the pixel, so their campaigns are judged and tuned on real results.



## Contextual usage

With CAPI connected, bookings still get reported even when a guest's browser blocks the pixel.

### TWO ROUTES TO META



#### The browser: the pixel

- Code on the booking page tells Meta "a booking happened".
- Blocked by ad blockers and phone privacy settings.
- Some bookings never get counted.



#### The server: CAPI

- The booking engine tells Meta directly.
- Nothing in the browser can block it.
- A shared event ID, so one booking isn't counted twice.

# Incrementality

did the ad cause the booking?



## Dictionary

Whether a booking actually happened because of the advertising, or would have happened anyway.



## Why the owner cares

It answers whether their ad money created bookings or only took credit for ones that were coming anyway. The way to know is a holdout: one group sees the campaign, a matched group is kept out of it, and the difference is the lift.

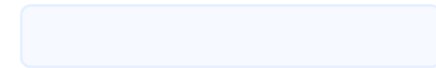


## Contextual usage

The real test is incrementality — did the ads bring in bookings that wouldn't have happened anyway?

ONE MONTH, ONE PROPERTY, TWO MATCHED AREAS

Exposed area, ads on



50 bookings

Holdout area, ads off



15 bookings

The lift: caused by the ads



35 bookings

Made-up numbers. The lift is the incremental part; Meta's report would have claimed all 50.

# Cannibalization

when the promo moves revenue instead of adding it



## Dictionary

When an ad, promotion or channel takes bookings the resort would have gotten anyway, instead of creating new ones. The numbers look like growth, but revenue has only moved around, often at a higher cost.



## Why the owner cares

It makes marketing look like growth when revenue has only moved around, often at a higher cost. It is the same fear as incrementality, seen from the promotion's side. The fix is a fence: conditions on the discount.



## Contextual usage

Before we celebrate the promo, let's check for cannibalization — were those guests going to book anyway?

WHERE A 10% BOOK-DIRECT CODE'S 120 REDEMPTIONS LANDED

**Peak Saturdays, would have booked anyway** 90

**Soft dates, new bookings** 30

**Given away: 10% on 90 stays, to win 30**

The fence: blackout dates for weekends and holidays, soft dates only, owned channels only, a cap on depth and frequency, a real deadline, reset each season.

# Fill the blank



Five lines you'd say to an owner, each with a blank.



Four ways to fill it. Hold up the number of the right one.



Three, two, one, vote. The finished line is one worth keeping.

# Fill the blank

FILL THE LINE · 1 OF 5

**"Your CPM went up this month, which usually means \_\_\_\_."**

Said to Marisol, about Lakeside Lodge's Meta report.



FILL THE LINE · 1 OF 5

## Cast your vote

**1** the ads stopped working

**2** more advertisers, same people

**3** Meta raised its fees

**4** the pixel is broken

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Fill the blank

**"Your CPM went up this month, which usually means \_\_\_\_."**

## WHY

**CPM is the price of attention in an auction.** When it rises, more advertisers are bidding for the same people: Q4, the holidays, a big launch nearby. It says nothing on its own about whether the ads worked (that's CPB and the holdout), Meta has no fee to raise, and a broken pixel changes what gets reported, not what an impression costs.

**"Your CPM went up this month, which usually means we're competing with more advertisers for the same people."**



THE ANSWER

## The answer

- 1 the ads stopped working
- ☒ 2 more advertisers, same people
- 3 Meta raised its fees
- 4 the pixel is broken

# Fill the blank

FILL THE LINE · 2 OF 5

**"We tag every link with a UTM so we can see \_\_\_\_."**

Said to Priya, who asked what the long links in her emails are for.



FILL THE LINE · 2 OF 5

## Cast your vote

- 1 which post or email brought it
- 2 how many saw the ad
- 3 if the pixel was blocked
- 4 what the OTAs charge

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Fill the blank

"We tag every link with a UTM so we can see \_\_\_\_."

## WHY

**A UTM tags the link, so the booking engine can say where the click came from.** That's the source of each booking: this post, that email. Impressions are Meta's count, not the link's; a blocked pixel is what CAPI is for; the OTAs' prices are rate shopping.

**"We tag every link with a UTM so we can see exactly which post or email brought each booking."**



THE ANSWER

## The answer



**which post or email brought it**

2

how many saw the ad

3

if the pixel was blocked

4

what the OTAs charge

# Fill the blank

FILL THE LINE · 3 OF 5

**“With CAPI connected, bookings still get reported even when \_\_\_\_.”**

Said to Ines, whose developer has just set it up.



FILL THE LINE · 3 OF 5

## Cast your vote

- 1** the owner forgets to tell us
- 2** the booking engine is down
- 3** the browser blocks the pixel
- 4** the guest books by phone

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Fill the blank

**“With CAPI connected, bookings still get reported even when \_\_\_\_.”**

## WHY

**CAPI sends the booking from the server, so it doesn't depend on the guest's browser.** The pixel is browser-side and can be blocked; the server route survives that. It can't report a booking the engine never took, and it isn't a substitute for the owner telling us anything.

**“With CAPI connected, bookings still get reported even when a guest's browser blocks the pixel.”**



THE ANSWER

## The answer

- 1 the owner forgets to tell us
- 2 the booking engine is down
- ☒ 3 the browser blocks the pixel
- 4 the guest books by phone

# Fill the blank

FILL THE LINE · 4 OF 5

**“The real question is incrementality: did the ads bring in bookings that \_\_\_\_?”**

Said to Theo, who wants to know if the ads are worth it.



FILL THE LINE · 4 OF 5

## Cast your vote

- 1** cost less than the OTA
- 2** came in on a promo code
- 3** the pixel could see
- 4** wouldn't have happened anyway

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Fill the blank

**"The real question is incrementality: did the ads bring in bookings that \_\_\_\_?"**

## WHY

**Incrementality asks what the ads added, not what they touched.** A booking can be cheaper than an OTA's cut, carry a promo code and be seen by the pixel, and still be one that was coming anyway. The holdout is how you find out.

**"The real question is incrementality: did the ads bring in bookings that wouldn't have happened anyway?"**



THE ANSWER

## The answer

- 1 cost less than the OTA
- 2 came in on a promo code
- 3 the pixel could see
- ☒ wouldn't have happened anyway

# Fill the blank

FILL THE LINE · 5 OF 5

**"Before we celebrate the promo, let's check for cannibalization: were those guests \_\_\_\_?"**

Said to Walt, whose 15%-off code did 60 redemptions last month, most of them on Saturdays that sell out anyway.



FILL THE LINE · 5 OF 5

## Cast your vote

- 1** going to book anyway
- 2** new to the property
- 3** on the OTAs first
- 4** staying on a weekend

Vote first. Then the answer.

# Fill the blank

**"Before we celebrate the promo, let's check for cannibalization: were those guests \_\_\_\_?"**

## WHY

**Cannibalization is a discount given to a booking that was coming anyway.** Walt's Saturdays sell out at full rate, so most of those 60 redemptions moved revenue and gave 15% away. Whether the guests were new, on an OTA or on a weekend doesn't settle it; whether they'd have booked without the code does. Point the code at the soft dates.

**"Before we celebrate the promo, let's check for cannibalization: were those guests going to book anyway?"**



THE ANSWER

## The answer



**going to book anyway**

2

new to the property

3

on the OTAs first

4

staying on a weekend

# Block 6: the stack

Five terms about the systems a property runs on, and the names you'll hear.

01



## The tools map

PMS, channel manager, booking engine, dynamic pricing: one slide each.

02



## Rate shopping and market intelligence tools

What the neighbours charge tonight.

03



## CRM tools

Customer relationship management: where the guest list lives.

04



## Guest messaging tools

Texts and chats around the stay.

05



## Upsell tools

The upgrade sold before the guest arrives.

# PMS

## property management system

The front desk's system: every reservation lives in it, guests are checked in from it, and the night's numbers come out of it. Everything else in the stack connects to the PMS.



### Mews

Cloud PMS for independent hotels and resorts, sold with its own booking engine. The name you'll hear most from our ICP.



### Oracle OPERA Cloud

The big-brand PMS: Hyatt chose it, and IHG approves it. A resort that came from a brand may still be on it.



### Cloudbeds

One suite for independents: PMS, channel manager and booking engine in one product. Ask what they use it for.



### Newbook

From the campground and holiday-park world, where many glamping stacks start. Also sells channel management.



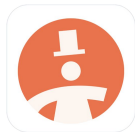
### WebRezPro

Cloud PMS aimed at independent hotels, lodges and inns, with its own booking engine.



### RMS Cloud

PMS for parks, resorts and hotels, with channel management and a booking engine in the same suite.



### Little Hotelier

SiteMinder's all-in-one for small properties: a PMS with the channel manager and booking engine built in.



### Guesty

Vacation-rental software: PMS and channel manager in one, with Hostaway as its closest peer.

Cloudbeds, RMS Cloud, Little Hotelier, Newbook, Guesty and Lodgify also sit in the channel manager and booking engine boxes.

# Channel manager one feed of rates and rooms to every OTA

Sends the property's rates and availability out to every OTA at once, and brings their bookings back, so a room sold on Booking.com disappears from Expedia before it is sold twice.



## SiteMinder

The name you'll hear most. A channel manager first, with a booking engine; its small-property PMS is a separate product, Little Hotelier.



## STAAH

Channel manager for independent properties, with its own booking engine and website tools.



## RateGain

Distribution and rate tools for hotels; it also sells the rate-shopping tools on slide 40.



## Hostaway

A vacation-rental PMS first, with channel manager, booking engine, pricing, messaging & upsells, for managers with many units.



## Cloudbeds

The channel manager inside the Cloudbeds suite, feeding the OTAs straight from its own PMS.



## DerbySoft

Connectivity for larger hotels and chains: links the property's systems to the OTAs and to Google.



## Guesty

Vacation rentals: PMS and channel manager in one product, pushing listings to Airbnb, Vrbo and Booking.com.



## Lodgify

Vacation rentals: a website with the booking engine built in, plus a channel manager to the OTAs.

SiteMinder, Cloudbeds and STAAH also sell a booking engine; Guesty, Hostaway and Lodgify are rental suites.

# Booking engine the Book now page on the owner's own site

The “Book now” page on the property's own website: it takes the direct booking, charges the card and writes the reservation into the PMS. Direct bookings, first-party data and our tracking all run through it.



## Sabre SynXis

SynXis's booking engine (sold by Sabre until 2025), on its central reservation system. The larger-hotel end of this box.



## Amadeus iHotelier

Amadeus' booking engine for hotels and resorts, often paired with its central reservation system.



## SiteMinder

Sold alongside its channel manager, so one vendor covers the OTAs and the direct page.



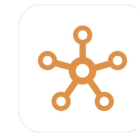
## Cloudbeds

The booking engine inside the Cloudbeds suite, writing straight into its own PMS.



## Mews

Sold with its PMS: the direct booking lands in the same system the front desk runs.



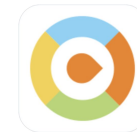
## STAAH

Sold with its channel manager, for independent properties.



## Lodgify

A vacation-rental website with the booking engine built in; the owner's site and the engine are one product.



## WebRezPro

The booking engine that comes with its PMS, for independent hotels and lodges.

Most PMS and channel-manager vendors sell an engine too; ask which one the owner's site actually uses.

# Dynamic pricing prices that move with demand

Rates moving automatically with demand; the category Wheelhouse and PriceLabs sit in.



## PriceLabs

Pricing for short-term and vacation rentals, increasingly small hotels. Plugs into the PMS and moves the nightly rate.



## Wheelhouse

Dynamic pricing for short-term and vacation rentals; the same job as PriceLabs, from the same world.



## Beyond

Vacation-rental pricing and revenue tools; formerly Beyond Pricing, so owners may use the old name.



## IdeaS

A hotel revenue-management system: the bigger-hotel end of this box. Forecasts demand, sets rates.



## Duetto

Hotel revenue-management system; IdeaS' main rival at resorts and groups.



## Atomize

Automated pricing for hotels; now sold as Mews RMS, part of Mews.



## RoomPriceGenie

Automated pricing for smaller hotels, B&Bs and inns that can't run a revenue manager.



## Cloudbeds

A pricing tool inside the Cloudbeds suite; an owner on Cloudbeds may run that instead of a separate one.

IdeaS, Duetto and Atomize are sold as revenue-management systems; PriceLabs, Wheelhouse and Beyond as dynamic pricing. Same box.

# Rate shopping and market intelligence tools the neighbours' prices

Watching comp-set rates automatically; Lighthouse, formerly OTA Insight.



## Lighthouse

Rate shopping: the comp set's prices, date by date. Formerly OTA Insight; it also sells pricing.



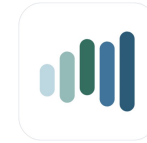
## RateGain

Rate intelligence for hotels, alongside its distribution tools.



## STR, part of CoStar

Benchmarking: how the comp set performed last month, on occupancy, ADR and RevPAR.



## KeyData

Benchmarking for short-term and vacation rentals, built from managers' own data.



## AirDNA

Vacation-rental market data: what the area's rentals charge and earn.



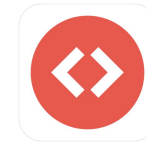
## Amadeus Demand360

Forward-looking demand data: what's on the books for the market, not just what was.



## Cloudbeds

A rate-shopping view inside the suite, so a Cloudbeds owner may already have one.



## PriceLabs

Dynamic pricing first; market data and rate shopping come with its pricing tool.

Rate shopping answers "what are they charging tonight?"; benchmarking answers "how did they do last month?". Owners lump both together.

# CRM tools

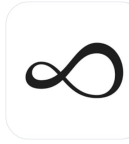
customer relationship management: where the guest list lives

Where guest data is held and segmented for marketing; Revinate, Cendyn.



## Revinate

Hotel CRM and email marketing: guest profiles, segments and campaigns, with reputation tools alongside.



## Cendyn

Hotel CRM, spelled C-e-n-d-y-n. Guest data and marketing automation for independents and groups.



## GoHighLevel

HGM's own CRM, with texting and chat built in: the leads and the email list the funnel builds.



## HubSpot

A general CRM some owners run, usually for sales enquiries rather than past guests.



## Mailchimp

The email tool a small owner often calls their CRM. A list and campaigns, not guest history.



## Klaviyo

Email and SMS with more automation than Mailchimp; the same role for a bigger list.



## Enso Connect

Guest experience platform that also sells guest segments and campaigns.



## Cloudbeds

A CRM inside the suite, as a paid add-on; ask what the owner means by CRM.

Mews keeps guest profiles, but connects to a CRM rather than being one. Two CRMs on every call: the property's, and the GoHighLevel list we build.

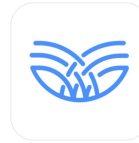
# Guest messaging tools the conversation before, during and after the stay

Pre-arrival and in-stay messaging to the guest; Duve, and Whistle (now part of Cloudbeds).



## Duve

Guest communication hub for hotels and rentals: messages, check-in and a guest app, with upsells built in.



## Canary Technologies

Hotel guest messaging, digital check-in and upsells in one platform.



## Whistle

Guest messaging, now part of Cloudbeds, so a Cloudbeds owner may already have it.



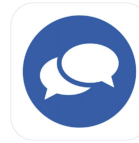
## Akia

Messaging for hotels and rentals: texts and automated replies around the stay.



## Enso Connect

Guest experience platform for vacation rentals and boutique stays: messaging, check-in, upsells.



## Kipsu

Hotel guest messaging by text, used by brands and independents.



## Mews

Messaging add-ons inside the PMS; some properties never buy a separate tool.



## Guesty

Vacation-rental suite with guest messaging built in, so a Guesty owner may never buy a separate tool.

Canary, Duve and Enso Connect sell upsells too, so they come back on the next slide.

# Upsell tools

the upgrade sold before, and at, arrival

Paid upgrades before and at arrival; Oaky (part of Plusgrade since 2025).



**Oaky**  
Hotel upsells by email and at check-in: the better room, the late checkout. Part of Plusgrade since 2025.



**Nor1**  
Oracle's upsell product, built to pair with OPERA, so brand-origin resorts may have it.



**Plusgrade**  
The group Oaky now belongs to; started in airline upgrades, now hotels too.



**UpsellGuru**  
Hotel upsells, including letting guests bid for an upgrade before arrival.



**Canary Technologies**  
Messaging plus upsells, sold as one platform.



**Duve**  
Messaging plus upsells, for hotels and rentals.



**Enso Connect**  
Messaging plus upsells, for rentals and boutique stays.



**Mews**  
Extras and upgrades offered in its own booking engine; some owners stop there.

Canary, Duve and Enso Connect are messaging tools that sell upsells too; some platforms do both.

# Sort the stack



Point your phone's camera at the code, then tap the link that appears.



If it asks you to sign in, use your HGM Google account.



On the call? The same link is in the meeting chat.



[hgmportal.com/dictionary/tools/review](https://hgmportal.com/dictionary/tools/review)

# What you have, and where it lives



## The HGM portal

Everything below lives at hgmportal.com. Sign in with your HGM Google account.



## The dictionary

253 terms in nine sections. Type a few letters and the term opens in full.



## Term check and term practice

The check after the sessions, and a practice mode you can run any time, on any term.



## Tool check and tool practice

The same two modes for the vendor names in block 6: which box does it go in?



## The PDFs

The call cheat sheets and the Client Tech Stack Guide, readable in the portal and sent to you after the session.

# Where this goes from here

**1** Don't know a term? Ask which they mean, then open the dictionary page.

**2** Ask one question from these two sessions on your next owner call.

**3** Check Kyle's daily update: a term a day, for the foreseeable future.

"Two Wednesdays ago we couldn't have told you what RevPAR was.

Now we can ask an owner how October's pacing, and mean it."